Data Retention and Privacy Policy

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1. Retention Schedule

Record type	Retention period
Financial and tax records	7 years
Employee personnel files	7 years after termination
Customer contracts	6 years after expiration
Customer production data	Duration of contract + 90 days
Application and security logs	1 year
Recruiting records for candidates not hired	2 years
Email	3 years, unless under legal hold

2. Legal Holds

When Legal issues a legal hold, all relevant records must be preserved regardless of the retention schedule until Legal releases the hold in writing. Deleting records under legal hold is a serious violation.

3. Data Subject Requests

Requests from individuals to access, correct, or delete their personal data (under GDPR, CCPA/CPRA, or PIPEDA) must be forwarded to privacy@helios.example.com within 2 business days of receipt. The Privacy Office must respond within 30 days for GDPR requests and within 45 days for CCPA/CPRA requests.

4. Data Breaches

Any suspected breach of personal data must be reported to the Security team immediately. The Privacy Office decides whether regulators must be notified; under GDPR the deadline is 72 hours after becoming aware of the breach.

5. Privacy by Design

New products and features that process personal data require a Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA) before launch. The PIA template is available in the Legal space of the knowledge portal.